

LOOT TABLE WORKS

GULLWATCH HARBOR

A FOUR-SESSION SYSTEM-NEUTRAL FANTASY CAMPAIGN



3-6 PLAYERS | FOUR LINKED SESSIONS

Gullwatch Harbor

A Four-Session System-Neutral Fantasy Campaign

For: 3-6 players Play: four linked sessions Prep: 10-15 minutes per session

Start with a false warning light and finish with a harbor charter written by the table. Every supported Beacon ending changes the continuation without forcing a preferred canon.

Original system-neutral fantasy content. No outside rules, characters, settings, brands, or compatibility claims are required.

Text and visual production used generative AI tools under directed production, source-controlled continuity constraints, deterministic packaging, editorial review, and structured QA. The setting, product architecture, final selections, revisions, and release decisions are controlled by Loot Table Works.

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The copied relief manifest lacks a crescent watermark present only on pre-flood cargo records.	49
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Water in the vault drain pulses in the same three-beat rhythm as Gullwatch's answering signal.	49
Three chambers replay the same wreck warning with three different ship names.	50
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The unaltered ledger splits one stolen consignment between the marked outward tranche aboard Nera's target ship and a larger cache built into the Tidecourt drydock caissons.	50
The original relay charter expires any emergency custody after one tide unless renewed in public.	51
Fresh caisson bolts conceal relief crates behind the emergency flood wall.	51
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Part I: Run the Campaign

Campaign At A Glance

Session	Title	Table outcome
1	Signal at Gullwatch	Stop the false harbor code, save the answering ship, and decide the fate of Orren and the beacon.
2	The Ledger Tide	Secure the unaltered relief ledger before the Compact seals it or an angry harbor destroys its evidentiary value.
3	The Drowned Relay	Reach the relay beneath Gullwatch, recover the complete cargo bearings, and establish a custody rule before the old warning network is claimed.
4	The Harbor Chooses	Distribute the hidden relief, save the incoming ship, and establish a lasting rule for the warning network.

Every session ends with a decision that changes the next opening. The campaign never requires the group to choose a preferred canon ending.

What This Campaign Is About

Gullwatch Harbor is a campaign about warning systems, public memory, and the people asked to trust institutions that have already failed them. A false beacon code creates the first emergency. The following sessions reveal that the code, the stolen relief cargo, and the forgotten lower relay are parts of the same civic question: who may control information when lives depend on it?

The campaign does not hide a single correct ruler, faction, or ending. Every claimant has one legitimate need and one dangerous shortcut. The Old Harbor Compact can keep ships moving, but treats custody as ownership. Tidebreak can move aid past a blockade, but acts before anyone else can consent. The Archive Recovery Crews preserve records, but procedure can become delay. Deep Nest remembers the lower foundations, but can make an old veto absolute.

The party's decisions matter because the campaign asks them to name practical rules. "We keep the evidence safe" is not enough. The table must decide who holds it, who receives a copy, how long the arrangement lasts, who can stop abuse, and what happens after a breach. Those details become visible in later scenes.

The Four-Session Shape

Session 1: Signal At Gullwatch

A dark beacon sends a false harbor code and an answering grain ship turns toward the reef. The party chooses an approach to the tower, discovers the conflict among Mara, Nera, and Orren, and decides what the coast will remember. The ending establishes the first fact that cannot be reset.

Session 2: The Ledger Tide

The false signal leads to an altered relief manifest and an unaltered ledger inside a flooded record house. The party chooses lawful access, public pressure, or a covert route, then defines temporary custody while real relief remains delayed.

Session 3: The Drowned Relay

The ledger points beneath Gullwatch. The party enters an older warning archive, meets the lower-foundation keeper, and discovers that the network once divided authority between surface and lower keepers. The settlement they test here becomes the model offered to the harbor.

Session 4: The Harbor Chooses

A storm, a hidden relief cache, and an incoming ship force evidence, distribution, and rescue into the same public assembly. The party must operate three signal masts and write a charter with an actual custodian, limit, witness, stop condition, distribution rule, and breach consequence.

Ten-Minute Campaign Start

- 1 Tell the players that the party has arrived in Gullwatch Harbor before a severe flood tide.
- 2 Read the strong start for Session 1.
- 3 Put the Flood Tide and False Signal clocks where everyone can see them.
- 4 Introduce Mara through the signal key, Nera through the damaged approach, and Orren through the light.
- 5 Ask the party to choose the bridge, cliff ladder, or wreck channel.

Do not explain the entire harbor before play. The setting becomes useful as the party needs it. A character who studies the light learns about the code. A character who protects the ship learns about the relief. A character who listens to the tower learns about Orren.

Fifteen-Minute Session Preparation

For Sessions 2-4:

- 1 Read the current objective and five scene titles.
- 2 Copy the four clock values from the previous continuity record.
- 3 Choose two continuing characters whose positions will be most visible.
- 4 Write one image that demonstrates each fact recorded last session.
- 5 Put the closing decision where the players can see it.

Budget 160 minutes for the five playable scenes. Reserve the remaining 20 minutes of the three-hour table window for transitions, one short break, and the continuity closeout.

Stop preparing when those steps are complete. The scenes contain enough pressure and alternatives to respond to the group. Predetermining a faction victory weakens the campaign because it turns the party's practical rules into decoration.

Table Contract

The campaign features flooding, ship danger, institutional neglect, disputed relief, strikes, memory loss, and public accusations. Before play, name those elements plainly. Ask the group which details should remain offscreen, which can be described without lingering, and which are welcome sources of tension.

No scene requires cruelty toward civilians, interrogation, or lethal force. Every active threat has a break condition. A group may bargain, expose a contradiction, create a safe route, protect a witness, or change the environment instead of fighting.

Keep a simple pause tool available. Any participant may ask to pause, revise a detail, move past a description, or take a break without explaining why. When play resumes, preserve the decision and change the presentation.

System-Neutral Resolution

This book describes stakes, pressure, endurance, approaches, and break conditions. Translate them into the procedures your table already understands.

Pressure is the severity of a meaningful consequence from 1 to 5. It is not a damage number.

Endurance marks show how many meaningful changes are needed before an opponent, hazard, or position breaks. They are not hit points.

A risky success normally removes one mark or completes one step.

A decisive exploit normally removes two marks or completes two linked steps.

A break condition ends the encounter regardless of remaining marks.

A failed action changes position, advances a visible clock, spends an opportunity, separates an ally, or exposes a cost. It never erases a required clue.

When the party has already solved the central problem, let the scene end. Do not require extra rolls to confirm an answer the table has made true.

Scale For The Group

Use the low values for a group learning a new rules system, a party with few ways to absorb consequences, or a session that needs faster movement. Use the middle values for most experienced groups. Use the high values when the group has broad fictional authority, reliable recovery, or strong control over the scene.

Scale position before durability. Add a failing bridge, divided witnesses, or a moving tide before adding marks. A longer encounter is not automatically a more dramatic encounter.

For three players, let one trusted ally hold a secondary objective without rolling. For six players, separate simultaneous objectives across different positions so every player has a decision. Never add another objective merely to keep someone busy.

The Saltglass Coast

A Coast Built On Warnings

The Saltglass Coast is a chain of steep harbors, black tidal shelves, and flooded foundations. Trade depends on warning lights because the safe channels move with storm deposits and collapsed seawalls. Old beacons do more than mark rocks. They carry route codes, cargo priority, flood instructions, and the names of missing ships.

People read a signal by color, rhythm, shutter interval, and the position that answers it. A true warning is rarely one light. It is an agreement among different keepers who can see different parts of the danger.

The coast's oldest charters recognized that fact. Surface keepers watched traffic. Lower-foundation keepers watched currents and structural pressure. Later institutions simplified the system, erased shared custody, and made one office responsible for every signal. Gullwatch Harbor inherited the speed and the vulnerability of that change.

Gullwatch Harbor

Gullwatch is large enough to matter and small enough for a decision to become personal. The harbor repairs ships, stores flood relief, and transfers cargo between deep-draft vessels and the narrow coastal routes. Its slate roofs climb from public quays toward old record halls. Beneath them, drains, bell chambers, and tidal foundations reach farther than current maps admit.

The harbor is not uniformly corrupt or uniformly oppressed. Workers, wardens, pilots, archivists, salvagers, and flood-district families depend on one another while distrusting the systems that assign priority. The campaign's conflict works because removing one group does not solve the harbor.

What Everyone Knows

- Gullwatch Beacon has been dark for thirteen years.
- The Old Harbor Compact controls the current codebook.
- Flood-district relief arrived late and some shipments disappeared.
- Brine corsairs use routes official pilots will not acknowledge.
- The black channel is a name for both a dangerous route and a warning no office wants to record.

What The First Session Reveals